

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

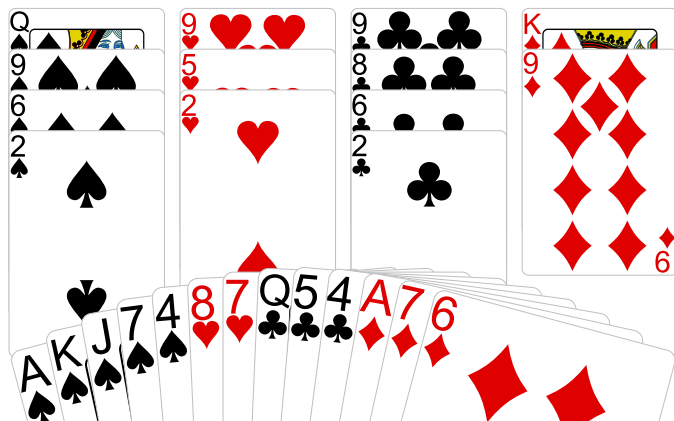
Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

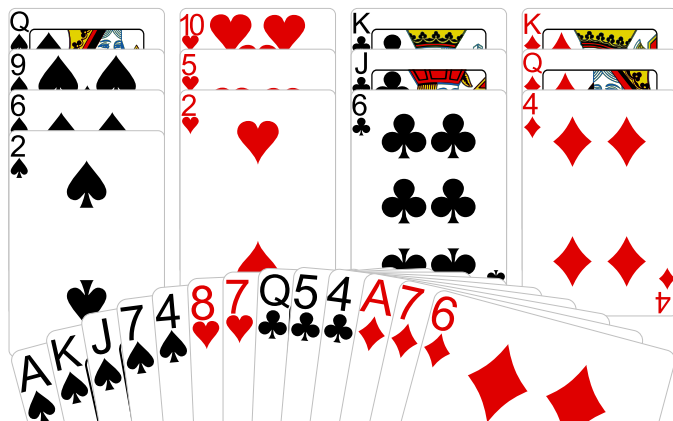
- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 1 ♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



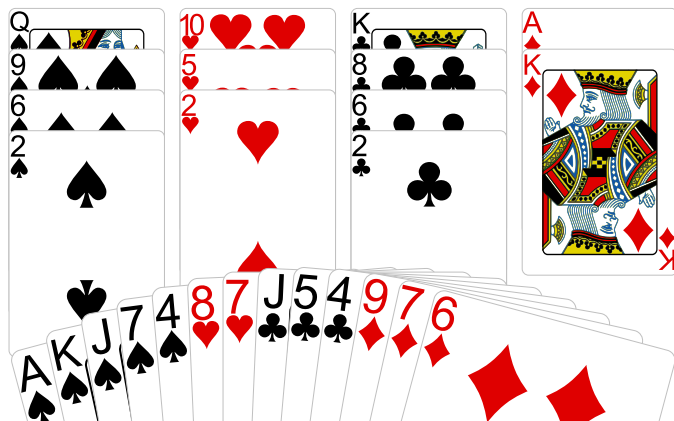
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4 ♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3 ♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4 ♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 1 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3 ♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: West

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
 ♥ A J T 6
 ♦ Q 8 3 2
 ♣ K J 3

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4



♠ T 5
 ♥ K Q 4 3
 ♦ J T 5 4
 ♣ A T 7

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2

NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to the punch by opening 1♥.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

West

1♥

All Pass

1♠ by North

North

1♠

East

South

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ K Q 4

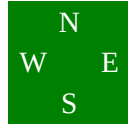
♣ K J 6

♠ 8 5

♥ K 9 4 3

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 9 7



♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

♠ T 3

♥ A Q J 6

♦ T 8 5

♣ T 8 3 2

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

1 ♥

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

Pass

4 ♠

4 ♠ by East

EAST has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s. But NORTH beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

WEST has 11 points, and if EAST had opened she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1 ♠ Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

EAST actually has a strong Overcall so he bids 4 ♠.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 8
♥ K 9 6 3
♦ J 8 5 2
♣ A Q 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2



♠ 5 3

♥ A Q J 4

♦ Q T 4 3

♣ T 9 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4

This time SOUTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when EAST opens 1♥ SOUTH should Overcall 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

NORTH has 13 points. If SOUTH had actually OPENED 1♠, NORTH would insist on game. But SOUTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So NORTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3♠ and SOUTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			
3♠ by South			

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A T 5 3

♥ T 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

♠ Q J 7

♥ K 9 8 2

♦ J 6 5 2

♣ J 4



♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5

♠ 4 2

♥ A Q J 6 3

♦ T 9 4

♣ T 9 3

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

1 ♥

Dbl

Pass

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

EAST has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

WEST needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise EAST of her 10 points. She jumps to 2 ♠.

EAST's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4 ♠.